COST Action
Final Achievement Report

(22/09/2022 to 21/09/2026)

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CA21129: What are Opinions? Integrating Theory and Methods for Automatically Analyzing Opinionated Communication

The Action was approved by the Committee of Senior Officials (CSO) on 27-5-2022 and has the MoU reference COST 043/22.

This report shows the data entered into e-COST to enable the Action Chair to verify the completeness and accuracy of the report with the MC prior to submitting the report via e-COST in fulfilment of the rules for COST Action Management, Monitoring and Final Assessment.

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Action leadership and participants

Leadership positions

Position	Name	Contact details	Country*
Chair	Prof Christian Baden	c.baden@mail.huji.ac.il +972774380556	Israel

Position	Name	Contact details	Country*
Action Vice-Chair	Prof Helle Sjøvaag	helle.sjovaag@uis.no +4798441989	Norway

Working groups

#	WG Title	# of participants	WG Leader	Country*
1	Theory	99	Prof Agnieszka Stepinska agnieszka.stepinska@amu.edu.pl	Poland
2	Tools	116	Dr Johannes B. Gruber johannesb.gruber@gmail.com	Germany
3	Data Management & Application	77	Prof Hajo Boomgaarden hajo.boomgaarden@univie.ac.at	Austria
4	Inclusion & Dissemination	62	Dr Carlos Arcila Calderón carcila@usal.es	Spain

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Other key leadership positions

Position	Name	Contact details	Country*
Science Communication Coordinator	Dr Ana Milojevic	anamilojevic@gmail.com	Serbia
GH Scientific Representative	Kasper Welbers	kasperwelbers@gmail.com	Netherlands

* The country displayed is:

- for the Action Chair, the country that nominated that person to the Management Committee before they were elected Action Chair;
- for the Action Vice-Chair the country that nominated the person as a Management Committee Member,
- for all other leadership positions, if the person is a MC Member the country displayed is the country of nomination, otherwise it is the country of the person's primary work affiliation.

Participants

COST members having accepted the MoU

AL	22/06/2022	AM	09/01/2023	AT	22/06/2022	BE	22/06/2022	BA	22/06/2022
BG	22/06/2022	HR	22/06/2022	CY	22/06/2022	CZ	22/06/2022	DK	22/06/2022
EE	22/06/2022	FI	22/06/2022	FR	22/06/2022	GE	22/06/2022	DE	22/06/2022
EL	22/06/2022	HU	22/06/2022	IS	22/06/2022	IE	22/06/2022	IL	22/06/2022
IT	22/06/2022	LV	22/06/2022	LT	22/06/2022	LU	22/06/2022	MT	22/06/2022
MD	22/06/2022	ME	22/06/2022	NL	22/06/2022	MK	22/06/2022	NO	22/06/2022
PL	22/06/2022	PT	22/06/2022	RO	22/06/2022	RS	22/06/2022	SK	22/06/2022
SI	22/06/2022	ZA	22/06/2022	ES	22/06/2022	SE	22/06/2022	CH	22/06/2022
TR	22/06/2022	UA	22/06/2022	UK	22/06/2022				

Other participants

Institution Name	Country

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Summary

Main aim/ objective

address the lack of shared conceptualizations of opinions and their expression (Theory challenge); the limited scope of existing computational tools (Tools challenge); the absence of gold standards in data management and analysis (Data challenge); and acute training needs in the analysis of large-scale opinionated texts (Training challenge)

The Action addressed this as described below

OPINION constituted a concerted effort at coordinating and advancing the state of text-based opinion research at a critical moment in history. Coinciding with the emergence of Generative Large Language Models (colloquially known as AI), OPINION not only undertook a prime effort at systematically evaluating the capacities and limitations of this new technology for valid, systematic research; it also confronted the rapid diversification of opinion expressions due to the availability of AI, raising new challenges for research (e.g., visual and multimodal contents, inauthentic expressions, AI slop). To enable high-quality research, and do so in a way that enables cross-disciplinary collaboration and inter-cultural comparison, OPINION focused on sharpening conceptual foundations, validating methods and tools, and enabling researchers to use computational methods in a circumspect, reflexive manner. Conceptually, OPINION has brought together decades of research across half a dozen disciplines in the social sciences, humanities, and information sciences, to distill common approaches, define core constructs, and identify core research agendas. Methodologically, OPINION has offered a much-needed systematization of key capabilities and methodological demands, offering clear guidelines for the choice and application of computational methods, and leading the way toward scrupulous validation and critique. This effort is accompanied by OPINION's investment into making tools, data and materials findable, accessible, interoperable and replicable (FAIR), collaborating with the European research infrastructure initiative MeDem to enable future research. Over its lifetime, OPINION has trained more than a hundred researchers in its approaches, tools and technologies, and created open access teaching materials, standards and recommendations designed to advance the theoretical, methodological and applied state of text-based opinion research. OPINION's outcomes and resources - its literature reviews, glossary, data and tool repositories, conceptual and methodological recommendations and various teaching resources - can be found at www.opinion-network.eu.

Action website

https://www.opinion-network.eu/

Achievement of MoU objectives, deliverables and additional outputs/ achievements

MoU objectives

Please self-assess and describe the level of achievement of each MoU objective. For any MoU objectives that were less than 76% achieved please provide justification.

Please provide proof to enable the Action Rapporteur to confirm the level of achievement.

Mou objective	Bring together the necessary theoretical perspectives to foster the exchange of knowledge and develop a common understanding of opinions and their expressions in digital information environments, including journalism studies, discourse studies, media policy, political communication and information science.		
Type of objective	2.b Building a community around a new or emerging field of research 2.c Bridging separate fields of science/disciplines to achieve breakthroughs that require an interdisciplinary approach		
Level of achievement of MoU objective	76 - 100%	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of MoU objective	WG1 members have self-organized into several subgroups to collect and review relevant theoretical work from across all represented disciplines, producing four complementary review chapters (D1.1): One chapter focuses on linguistics, psycholinguistics, and cognitive approaches; one on cultural studies and political communication in a sociological perspective; one on communication and media studies from a more humanistic perspective; and one on public opinion research, political science, and marketing. Each chapter reviews theoretical foundations and definitions, key debates and bodies of research, as well as common methods deployed to study opinions in the reviewed disciplines. The chapters have been published online (https://www.opinion-network.eu/results), and constitute the opening four chapters in the book produced by WG1 (D1.3). Due to limited participation by members from information science and informatics, there is no review chapter on this body of work, however, the perspective has been articulated in group discussions and integrated into the development of common understandings. Through frequent exchanges across the subgroups and the subsequent work on the glossary (see below), WG1 has moreover created a deep transdisciplinary debate connecting and integrating divergent perspectives. Through an ongoing process of discussion, the drafting of definitions and glossary entries, and their systematic examination against different disciplinary traditions, WG1 has created an integrated terminology as well as precise, coherent operationalizations of opinion analysis, enabling a concise and efficient exchange of ideas and insights across disciplinary and academic traditions. The glossary has been published online (https://www.opinion-network.eu/glossary) and via the Zenodo Open Access repository (https://zenodo.org/records/15865458).		

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Mou objective	Design interdisciplinary Action Working Groups to foster connections between theory and methodology that will enable the integration and adaptation of tools developed in different contexts and languages, by different teams, projects and disciplines researching opinions.		
Type of objective	1.a Development of a common understanding/definition of the subject matter 2.a Building a community around a topic of scientific and/or socio-economic relevance, allowing for knowledge exchange and the development of a joint research agenda 2.b Building a community around a new or emerging field of research		
Level of achievement of MoU objective	76 - 100%	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High

Proof of achievement of MoU objective	OPINION has formed four interdisciplinary Action WGs: WG1: Theory, WG2: Tools, WG3: Application and Data, WG3: Inclusion and Dissemination, each of which tackled the need to connect theoretical demands and methodological practices from a slightly different angle. In WG1, work started from discipline-focused sub-groups (public opinion, political communication and cultural studies, linguistics, and media and communication) designed to collect and integrate similar perspectives on the study of opinion and identifying theoretical implications for research characteristic of each discipline. This systematic effort at cross-disciplinary integration resulted in the production of the aforementioned literature review chapters (D1.1), the glossary, the OPINION manifesto (D1.2), and the forthcoming book (D1.3). In both WG2 and WG3, work started from a systematic effort at inventorizing current approaches to studying opinionated text in different disciplines, focusing on the deployed tools (WG2) and kinds of data, respectively. The effort included a systematic review of large bodies of empirical and methodological work across all disciplines involved in OPINION, bringing together researchers all across the diverse fields. This effort then illuminated important contingencies between purposes, data, and tools, and enabled the identification of common combinations and foci of approaches and research agendas. In WG2, this resulted in the production of a tools inventory (D2.1, https://meteor.medem.eu/detail/collection_opiniontoolscostaction), a paper formulating concrete recommendations (D2.2), and numerous training materials (D3.3). In WG3, notably less work could be done, owing to a delayed start and limited participation (the original WG leader fell sick and it took long to restore effective leadership, so that by the time that WG3 was fully operational again, many members had migrated to other WGs), but also here, there has been a repository of data and uses (D3.1), as well as an effort at making concrete recommendations (D3.2). In WG4, efforts focused on identifying the key skills needed for researchers to translate theoretical demands into methodological strategies, use and adapt tools, and identify suitable applications of research across all involved disciplines. For its first training school, the working group focused on leveling up basic skills, while training schools no. three and four aimed at more specific challenges. In all four working groups, the ongoing collaboration has resulted in the formation of numerous smaller project teams spanning countries and languages, disciplines and fields, focused on specific challenges within the purview of the action. While some collaborations are primarily within-WG, drilling down on specific issues within the confines of the WG's work, most span multiple WGs, uniting theorists, methodologists, and applied researchers.

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Mou objective	Build and disseminate an integrated terminology of opinion research and measurement to enable inter-disciplinary research on opinions in the digital networked age.		
Type of objective	1.a Development of a common understanding/definition of the subject matter 1.e Development of knowledge needing international coordination, pertaining to a new or improved theory, model, methodology, technology or technique 2.c Bridging separate fields of science/disciplines to achieve breakthroughs that require an interdisciplinary approach		
Level of achievement of MoU objective	76 - 100%	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of MoU objective	Drawing upon the extensive literature reviews conducted by WG1, the group has constructed a glossary of 141 entries, each defining a core construct in the field of opinion research. For each entry, the objective was to integrate knowledge from different disciplines, and to mark important divergences in disciplinary perspectives, while highlighting areas of agreement and providing a consensus definition whenever possible. Each entry was reviewed by multiple peers within WG1, generally selected to assume a complementary perspective to that of the author, thus ensuring that all entries are accessible, accepted and practically relevant to all concerned disciplines. The glossary has been published online (https://www.opinion-network.eu/glossary) and via the Zenodo Open Access repository (https://zenodo.org/records/15865458) to enable researchers to refer to these definitions, fostering effective interdisciplinary knowledge exchange and collaboration. Moreover, numerous collaborative projects that have emerged from OPINION's work already draw upon definitions offered in the Glossary, practically increasing cohesion in the scientific debate.		

Mou objective	Establish a common methodological research agenda, identifying relevant focus areas to coordinate collaborative and comparative empirical research on opinions in online settings.		
Type of objective	1.b Coordination of information seeking, identification, collection and/or data curation 1.c Coordination of experimentation or testing 1.e Development of knowledge needing international coordination, pertaining to a new or improved theory, model, methodology, technology or technique		
Level of achievement of MoU objective	76 - 100%	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of MoU objective	OPINION has established a common methodological research agenda primarily through the work of WG2, with active contributions from the other WGs. Building upon a wide and encompassing collection and review of existing methodological approaches - notably, the repository of tools (D2.1, https://meteor.medem.eu/detail/collection_opiniontoolscostaction) and several review papers on existing uses - the WG has defined key methodological challenges for future opinion research, and started tackling some of these. One key outcome concerns the recommendations paper (D2.2), which guides researchers' choice of tools and strategies for future research (the paper is being finalized and will be submitted for publication soon). Another key component concerns the training schools, which have discussed key methodological challenges in the application of computational methods and generative AI, training participants on the current state of the art while flagging key areas of needed research. Several of the papers and presentations that came out of collaborations around WG2 have already begun addressing core issues within this research agenda, notably, the study of biases in Generative AI (e.g., Urman et al.; Bojic et al.); the need for cross-lingual and cross-cultural alignment (e.g., Milioni et al., Kristo et al.); and the improved integration of methodological strategies and conceptual demands (e.g., Baden et al., in the OPINION book).		

Mou objective	Set gold standards for data handling and validation to enable the evidence-based selection, adaptation and user-friendly application of tools, through the Computational Communication Lab.		
Type of objective	1.a Development of a common understanding/definition of the subject matter 1.d Comparison and/or performance assessment of a theory, model, methodology, technology or technique 1.g Input to stakeholders (e.g. standardization body, policy-makers, regulators, users), excluding commercial applications		
Level of achievement of MoU objective	51 - 75%	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of MoU objective	While WG3 has focused on the linking of data sources suitable for benchmarking and comparative evaluation, WG2 has invested into the testing of AI-based tools and is in the process of publishing a paper that makes concrete recommendations for applied text-based opinion research (D2.2). The guidance provided herein addresses the objective formulated prior to the advent of Generative AI, adapted to the age of Large Language Models. In view of the very different distribution of Generative AI applications, which are beginning to be embedded into very many online resources, offering similar capabilities there, the benefit of creating one central lab collecting tools, documentation and recommendations has essentially voided itself, so we have redirected our dissemination efforts toward the fields' general scientific discourses.		
Please provide a justification(s) for any MoU objectives that were less than 76% achieved.	Concerning data handling and the user-friendly application of tools, the advent of Generative AI has profoundly reshaped the field and changed the nature of most pressing needs. Had we originally foreseen that ordering the wild growth of tools, documenting and evaluating them, and offering specialized tutorials would constitute the primary challenge, resulting in the idea of a Lab, Generative AI has created a one-		

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	stop-shop that includes very many of the capabilities that used to be distributed over many tools. Similarly, if pre-AI computational analysis required detailed pre-processing routines, Generative Large Language Models ingest text pretty much as-is, extracting relevant information following prompts. Accordingly, while the inventory of tools (D2.1) or developing standards for data sharing and annotation (D3.1) remain useful achievements, WG2 and WG3 have otherwise shifted focus in the wake of Generative AI towards offering a structured evaluation and documentation of key capabilities and challenges in AI-based textual research.

Mou objective	Develop sustained exchange of knowledge with stakeholders in politics, regulatory authorities, and industry.		
Type of objective	1.j Dissemination of research results to stakeholders (excluding specific input in view of knowledge application) 2.d Acting as a stakeholder platform or trans-national practice community, pertaining to a certain area of socio-economical or societal application, or to a certain market sector 2.e Building capacity in the demographic inclusiveness of networks in science and technology, including representation of newly established research groups, Early-Career Investigators, the under-represented gender and teams from countries/regions with less capacity in the field of the Action		
Level of achievement of MoU objective	76 - 100%	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of MoU objective	To foster sustained dialogue across sectors, OPINION implemented a variety of targeted outreach initiatives, coordinated by the network's dedicated stakeholder liaison officer. Through a combination of direct interactions, multimedia outreach, and policy documents, OPINION undertook a concerted effort at establishing bridges between academic research and practical applications in politics, journalism, and public opinion measurement industry. Most saliently, Stakeholder Roundtables hosted at the network's final conference at VERN' University in Zagreb (Croatia) brought together pollsters, journalists, activists, and scholars. Each roundtable tackled topical aspects of opinionated communication, notably, "Weaponized opinions: Dealing with toxicity in digital discourse" and "Public opinion in the digital age: Participation, polarization, and pressure politics". These panels provided a forum to discuss critical challenges in opinion expression, measurement, and analysis, hate speech and toxicity, digital media dynamics, public opinion and polarization, and media pluralism. A project funded by the Jagiellonian University enabled OPINION to conduct a series of interviews with professional pollsters and opinion researchers, exchanging best practices and current concerns in the industry. Similarly, the Webinar on "Polling in the Digital Age: Challenges and Insights from Central and Eastern Europe" brought together industry stakeholders from Romania and Serbia, over a discussion of OPINION's themes and research agendas. The webinar aimed at engaging OPINION members and stakeholders from various fields related to public opinion. Addressing a wider audience of stakeholders, the Observing Opinion Podcast Series (https://aboutccs.net/opinion/) was designed to make computational communication and opinion research accessible beyond academia. The series serves as a durable educational resource, addressing methodological, theoretical, and ethical dimensions of working with digital opinion data for broader professional audiences. The OPINION Manifesto (https://www.opinion-network.eu/img/the-opinion-manifesto.pdf), finally, synthesizes key takeaways from the network's collective work, addressing practitioners and scholars across various industries and fields with critical advice on the conduct of opinion research in the digital information ecosystem. It defines key conceptual standards, ethical guidelines, and a forward-looking research agenda, offering a strategic reference point for industry practitioners, regulators, and political stakeholders, and has been disseminated directly toward relevant stakeholder groups, as well as via social media.		

Mou objective	Set up a dedicated Training Mission to facilitate the training of scholars, particularly PhD students, early career researchers and Inclusiveness Target Country (ITC) researchers in applying those tools to research problems and to include them in the

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	network.		
Type of objective	1.e Development of knowledge needing international coordination, pertaining to a new or improved theory, model, methodology, technology or technique 1.g Input to stakeholders (e.g. standardization body, policy-makers, regulators, users), excluding commercial applications 2.e Building capacity in the demographic inclusiveness of networks in science and technology, including representation of newly established research groups, Early-Career Investigators, the under-represented gender and teams from countries/regions with less capacity in the field of the Action		
Level of achievement of MoU objective	76 - 100%	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of MoU objective	OPINION's training mission was actualized primarily through its three training schools organized by WG4, and augmented numerous mobility grants, the compilation of publicly available training materials, as well as other online resources. To guide its training mission, OPINION conducted a survey early in its course to identify key training needs among its members. A key insight from this survey was that training needs were felt in different ways among junior scholars (who were often familiar with basic computational tools, but sought strategic advice and experience) and senior scholars (who felt confident on strategy, but needed training to better understand the capabilities and limitations of digital tools). As a result, WG4 designed its first training school to offer a focused introduction to digital methods, which was widely acclaimed among both junior and senior researchers (at all training schools, a majority of participants originated from ITCs). The two subsequent training schools then built on this knowledge to dive deeper into classic computational research tools and strategies, as well as the use of AI for opinion research. As an effect, the collected training materials created for these three training schools, which are available online, cover the entire bandwidth from beginners' uses of computational tools, to specialized challenges in application and validation (https://github.com/Opinion-CA21129/learning-materials/). Beside the training schools, OPINION also supported young scholars and ITC-based researchers by funding 24 STSMs motivated specifically by the need for specialized training (notably, most STSMs to Amsterdam, the foremost methods hub in the network). Beside these targeted uses, the Observing Opinion Podcast Series (https://aboutccs.net/opinion/) includes targeted advice for researchers entering into the field of text-based opinion research and guides listeners to key resources and materials.		

Mou objective	Organize master classes, summer schools, workshops and STSMs to train researches across ages, genders, institutions, countries, languages and disciplines to ensure that resources, tools and skills are spread and exchanged, enabling future research collaboration.		
Type of objective	1.e Development of knowledge needing international coordination, pertaining to a new or improved theory, model, methodology, technology or technique 2.b Building a community around a new or emerging field of research 2.e Building capacity in the demographic inclusiveness of networks in science and technology, including representation of newly established research groups, Early-Career Investigators, the under-represented gender and teams from countries/regions with less capacity in the field of the Action		
Level of achievement of MoU objective	76 - 100%	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of MoU objective	Over its course, OPINION organized four Master Classes, addressing various topics of critical importance to the network. At OPINION's 3rd Joint WG meeting in Limassol, Cyprus, Dr. Konstantinos Gemenis (Cyprus U of Technology) taught a class entitled "Reframing text mining on social media as a survey research task" (https://www.opinion-network.eu/updates/opinion%E2%80%99s-first-masterclass-in-limassol-cyprus_2024-01-31); at the 4th meeting in Salamanca, Spain, Dr. Johannes B. Gruber (GESIS) addressed "The Good, The Bad, and The Generated: Opinion Mining with		

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	(local) AI" (https://www.opinion-network.eu/updates/opinion%E2%80%99s-masterclass-in-salamanca-spain_2024-07-04); Prof. Damian Trilling (VU Amsterdam) addressed the network at its 5th Joint WG meeting in Lyon, France, discussing "What also non-nerds need to know about recent advances in computational methods" (https://www.opinion-network.eu/updates/opinions-masterclass-in-lyon-france_2025-02-18); and at the 6th Joint WG meeting in Elbasan, Albania, Dr. Dren Gërguri (U Prishtina) taught a class about "The role of Deepfakes in shaping digital opinion". OPINION organized three training schools (in Salamanca, Spain; Elbasan, Albania; and Zagreb, Croatia), each of which offered a dense 2-day curriculum focusing on introducing junior as well as experienced scholars to key concepts in computational opinion research; discussing key strategies in computational opinion research; as well as the use of Artificial Intelligence in opinion research, respectively. Each training school was attended by around 30 participants, a slight majority of whom were from ITCs, female, and relatively junior - except for the first training school, which specifically invited also senior, but computationally inexperienced senior scholars. OPINION's workshops include a works-in-progress preconference before the CompText Annual conference in Birmingham, attended by 20 members; a Hackathon organized as a preconference to the ECREA European Communication Conference in Ljubljana, attended by 18 members; a webinar for practitioners (see above); and the network funded 24 STSMs, most of them submitted by ITC and YRI scholars, and about half of them involving collaboration with a non-ITC scholar. There is now a lively community of diverse international, interdisciplinary collaborations, which has started showing up at conferences beyond OPINION, promising rich future work.

Mou objective	Establish a virtual Computational Communication Lab to render available key data sets for cross-lingual and comparative validation and benchmarking, develop critical gold standards, and provide targeted guidance for the integration and tailored application of tools and resources.		
Type of objective	1.b Coordination of information seeking, identification, collection and/or data curation 1.c Coordination of experimentation or testing 2.a Building a community around a topic of scientific and/or socio-economic relevance, allowing for knowledge exchange and the development of a joint research agenda		
Level of achievement of MoU objective	26 - 50%	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	Medium
Proof of achievement of MoU objective	In practice, that means that OPINION has chipped in to MeDem's efforts at developing its AmCAT text storage and analysis facility, as well as the METEOR database of key resources (data, tools, materials). A side effect of this strategy, as well as the personal overlap between both teams (to the point that the leader of WG3 is also the coordinator of the MeDem project), is that it is impossible to specify what exactly within the advances made to AmCAT and METEOR should be credited to either OPINION or MeDem; for us, what mattered is that we are building the resources we promised, while gaining additional scope and impact through this collaboration.		
Please provide a justification(s) for any MoU objectives that were less than 76% achieved.	For the provision of access to key data sets and resources, we have teamed up with the MeDem European Infrastructure Initiative, whose text-analytic resources emerged from the OPTED consortium, and whose core team overlapped heavily with OPINION. Instead of duplicating resources, we have collaborated with MeDem in the identification and documentation of data, along with the advancement of sharing and benchmarking standards. In view of MeDem vying to build similar resources to those envisaged by OPINION, but at a much larger scale and with direct funding for infrastructure development (MeDem is presently applying for institutional funding as a European Research Infrastructure), we decided against developing our own Computational Communication Lab, and instead merge our activities into the bigger infrastructure effort.		

Mou objective	Identify and establish cooperation with other research groups and projects relevant to the study of textually expressed opinions (e.g., the H2020 Research Infrastructure Project OPTED, the CLARIN network) and develop synergies.

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Type of objective	2.b Building a community around a new or emerging field of research 2.d Acting as a stakeholder platform or trans-national practice community, pertaining to a certain area of socio-economical or societal application, or to a certain market sector		
Level of achievement of MoU objective	76 - 100%	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of MoU objective	As noted in the previous point, OPINION has entered into sustained collaboration with MeDem, which incorporated the outcomes (and much of the team) of the OPTED research infrastructure initiative. Many of OPINION's outcomes are fed directly into MeDem's repositories and service centers, and OPINION has been an important space for MeDem to build its resources and recruit contributors. A second key collaboration concerns the global community of computational text-based researchers organized around the CompText association and annual conference. Again building on some personal overlaps (a majority of CompText's governing board also joined OPINION), we have developed joint initiatives, and notably, established CompText as a lifeline for the OPINION community to continue meeting and collaborating beyond the Action's limited funding period. Our preconference before the CompText conference in Birmingham served to connect members of both communities and encourage OPINION members to submit to and present at the CompText conference. Again, owing to some personal overlaps, it is difficult to quantify just how many of the presentations at CompText were enabled by OPINION, but we know that more than 25 OPINION members participated in the CompText event. Relations with the CLARIN research infrastructure were created primarily when OPINION was joined by a larger group of linguists who had previously collaborated via other COST actions, and who included several members involved in CLARIN, linking that body of data collections and tools to the OPINION activities, while also publishing to CLARIN's collection (e.g., Ruzaite et al.).		

Mou objective	Identify key stakeholders in politics, regulatory authorities, and industry and build collaborative stakeholder relations network.		
Type of objective	2.b Building a community around a new or emerging field of research 2.d Acting as a stakeholder platform or trans-national practice community, pertaining to a certain area of socio-economical or societal application, or to a certain market sector		
Level of achievement of MoU objective	76 - 100%	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of MoU objective	OPINION has compiled a comprehensive stakeholder list in most member countries of individuals and organizations whose work is relevant to and potentially affected by the action. Building on this collection, OPINION has established a dedicated stakeholder liaison officer, as well as several social media presences (notably, on LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/company/opinion-cost-action-ca21129/posts) and started connecting to various stakeholders while disseminating key network outcomes. Some OPINION members engaged in sustained stakeholder dialogue, communicating needs and haves between different communities (e.g., Dr. Bojic participated in European-level forums on AI governance). That said, we did not have sufficient resources to truly maintain a sustained exchange at the level of the entire network - partly because it took the network a while of internal discussions before we were in a position to address outside stakeholders with concrete insights, questions and agendas, and partly because parts of the network focused deeply on methodological and theoretical issues that are relatively far from stakeholders' more practical concerns. For the final conference in Zagreb (Croatia), we made a concerted effort to distil insights and recommendations relevant to stakeholders, which were disseminated both via two conference panels and the stakeholder roundtables on the second conference day, and also via posters prepared by network members (https://www.opinion-network.eu/results) that formed the base of wider online dissemination efforts.		

Mou objective	Establish the study of textually expressed opinions as an independent subfield and vibrant research community that will continue pursuing the action's shared research agenda beyond the duration of the action.

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Type of objective	2.a Building a community around a topic of scientific and/or socio-economic relevance, allowing for knowledge exchange and the development of a joint research agenda 2.b Building a community around a new or emerging field of research 2.c Bridging separate fields of science/disciplines to achieve breakthroughs that require an interdisciplinary approach		
Level of achievement of MoU objective	76 - 100%	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of MoU objective	OPINION's bid to establish textual opinion research as a field has been both massively aided and shaped by the advent of Generative AI. On the one hand, the facility of examining large amounts of textually expressed opinion using Large Language Models has already brought numerous researchers into the field of textual opinion research, and a vibrant community of researchers is rapidly taking shape. On the other hand, the same process has also brought many researchers into contact with textual research who do not necessarily come from a theoretically grounded engagement with textual opinion research, and who rely overly uncritically on the still ill-understood capacity of these novel technologies to deliver valid measurement. This has challenged OPINION over its lifetime to focus its effort on informing and shaping the community of text-based researchers, offering targeted training, evidence-based critique, and theoretical refinement in an effort to raise validity standards and shape the emerging quality standards of the field. Overall, we believe that we have been quite successful at this effort: As a network, OPINION has gathered a critical mass of leading scholars in this area, whose combined publications are already having an impact on the field and are beginning to be widely cited. Through our alliance with CompText, a community that is a bit wider thematically but shares OPINION's dedication to the advancement of text-based social research, OPINION is expanding its impact to the global scale. Throughout the lifetime of OPINION, several members have had their debut on the stage of global conferences, presenting to packed rooms at ACL, ICA, APSA and other conferences. While we can hardly claim credit for all of this effort, OPINION scholars have positioned themselves at the forefront of the global move toward text-based opinion research, upholding rigorous validity standards and shaping key research agendas.		

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Deliverables

This section covers only deliverables that were foreseen for the Action, not additional outputs that were generated during the Action (these additional outputs will be added in the following section). Please select and comment on the level of achievement of each deliverable as well as the extent to which the achievement was dependant on the Action networking.

For deliverables that are:

- Delivered, please provide proof to enable the Action Rapporteur to confirm the delivery
- Not delivered but delivery is foreseen within 2 years please explain how the delivery will be achieved
- Not foreseen to be delivered please explain why not

Deliverable	D1.1 Extensive literature review of existing theory and research on opinions and their textual/discursive expression (WG1 Theory)		
Level of achievement of deliverable	Delivered	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of deliverable	https://www.opinion-network.eu/img/opinion-wg1_literature-review_d1.1_april-2024.docx		

Deliverable	D1.2 Joint manifesto on conceptual criteria and dimensions of textually expressed opinions and resulting research agenda (WG1 Theory)		
Level of achievement of deliverable	Delivered	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of deliverable	https://www.opinion-network.eu/img/the-opinion-manifesto.pdf		

Deliverable	D1.3 Joint publication on a comprehensive theoretical framework for the study of textually expressed opinions in different kinds of discursive contexts (WG1 Theory)		
Level of achievement of deliverable	Not delivered, but foreseen within 2 years	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Explanation	The edited volume is under contract and accepted with Routledge, and the final manuscript has been transferred to the publisher. It is currently in production.		

Deliverable	D2.1 Inventory of existing tools for the measurement of textually expressed opinions and their components, to be published on the project website (WG2 Tools)		
Level of achievement of deliverable	Delivered	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of deliverable	https://meteor.medem.eu/detail/collection_opiniontoolscostaction		

Deliverable	D2.2 Joint publication on strategies and recommendations for the automated extraction of textually expressed opinions (WG2 Tools)		
Level of achievement of deliverable	Not delivered, but foreseen within 2 years	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Explanation	The paper is completed and in the process of being submitted for publication.		

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Deliverable	D2.3 Online teaching material and set of tutorials on the use of tools for extracting textually expressed opinions (WG2 Tools).		
Level of achievement of deliverable	Delivered	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of deliverable	https://github.com/Opinion-CA21129/learning-materials/		

Deliverable	D3.1 Data archival facility for opinionated text and interface for the application of key tools for the extraction of textually expressed opinions (WG3 Data management & Application)		
Level of achievement of deliverable	Delivered	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	Medium
Proof of achievement of deliverable	https://meteor.medem.eu/detail/collection_costopinion		

Deliverable	D3.2 Joint gold standards for the extraction of textually expressed opinions in different discursive contexts (WG3 Data management & Application)		
Level of achievement of deliverable	Not foreseen	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Explanation	WG3 ran into troubles early in the Action's lifetime, as the original chair fell sick and was unavailable, and the replacement chair missed the next meeting owing to flight cancellation. By the time that WG3 was back on track, WG members had moved to other WGs. Additionally, the rapidly rising role of AI has profoundly changed the nature of validation standards. WG3 has offered detailed information on documentation and data sharing standards, and there is a lot of work on validation standards all across OPINION. However, offering a single gold standard reference data set no longer made much sense.		

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Deliverable	D3.3 Computational Communication Lab as an open-access interactive online platform for the study of textually expressed opinions (WG3 Data management & Application)		
Level of achievement of deliverable	Not foreseen	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Explanation	As noted above, OPINION's plans to develop a Computational Communication Lab were transformed into joining forces with the more well-resourced MeDem initiative and contributing to the growing portfolio of services and resources available through their online presences and specialized service centers (notably, the one on text and multimedia). As a result of our choice not to duplicate, but rather to join that effort, there is therefore no separate OPINION Lab, but instead, a rich contribution by OPINION to the MeDem resource collection.		

Deliverable	D4.1 Action Website and concept for the online dissemination of key outcomes of the action (WG4 Inclusion & Dissemination)		
Level of achievement of deliverable	Delivered	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of deliverable	https://www.opinion-network.eu/		

Deliverable	D4.2 Inclusion strategy White Paper and Program schedule of planned training events

	(WG4 Inclusion & Dissemination)		
Level of achievement of deliverable	Delivered	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	Medium
Proof of achievement of deliverable	https://www.opinion-network.eu/img/stakeholder-analysis-and-engagement-strategy_v2_oct2023.docx		

Deliverable	D4.3 Joint White Paper on practice-based recommendations for inclusion in computational methods training and collaborative textual research (WG4 Inclusion & Dissemination)		
Level of achievement of deliverable	Delivered	**Dependence of achievement on the action networking**	High
Proof of achievement of deliverable	https://www.opinion-network.eu/img/joint-white-paper-d4.3_05.10.pdf		

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Additional outputs / achievements

Co-authored Action publications

Please enter below ONLY publications (including publications that are submitted but not yet accepted):

- that are on the topic of the Action, and
- that are co-authored by at least two Action participants from two countries participating in the Action, and
- for which the Action networking was necessary.

Please pay special attention to the COST Excellence and Inclusiveness policy and ensure the inclusion of publications with authors from COST Inclusiveness Target Countries (ITCs), from the underrepresented gender in the Action and from Early Career Investigators/Young researchers.

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	Bibliographic data	Countries participating in the Action among authors	Open Access	COST cited?	COST funds?	Relevance to H2020 Societal challenge	Peer Reviewed?
1	Stępińska, A., Cunha, C., Szabó, G., Krstić, A., & Bączkowska A. (forthcoming, Eds.). Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.	HU, PL, PT, RS	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
2	Baden, C., Cunha, C., Gogo, V., Hess, A., Jungblut, M., Bączkowska, A., Ciunova-Shuleska, A., Gërguri, D., Kunić, T., Negrea Busuioc, E., Palamidovska-Sterjadovska, N., Reci, A., Springer, N., Waldherr, A., & Zelenkauskaite, A. (forthcoming). Opinion in public opinion theory and research. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.	AL, AT, HR, DE, IL, LT, MK, PL, PT, RO	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
3	Szabó, G., Vochocová, L., Lipiński, A., Rosenfeldová, J., Bączkowska, A., Botan, M., Buturoiu, R., Corbu, N., Gërguri, D., Hess, A., & Stępińska, A. (forthcoming). Opinionated communication from the perspective of political communication and	CZ, HU, PL, RO	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y

	cultural studies. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.						
4	Bączkowska, A., Hess, A., Negrea Busuioc, E., Lipiński, A., Cunha, C., Guzek, D., Kunić, T., Milojevic, A., Novotna, M., Macková, A., Dylgjeri, A., Kazazi, L., Krstic, A., Ruzaitė, J., Lombart, E., Milioni, D., Zelenkauskaite, A., & Gogo, V., (forthcoming). Opinionated texts in communication and media studies: An overview of theoretical approaches. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.	AL, BE, HR, CY, CZ, LT, PL, PT, RO, RS	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
5	Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, B., Ruzaitė, J., Harpaz, G., Dylgjeri, A., Lombard, E., Kazazi, L., Liebeskind, C., Bolatbek, M., & Bączkowska, A., (forthcoming). Researching opinions: A multifaceted linguistic approach. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.	AL, BE, IL, LT, PL	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
6	Negrea Busuioc, E., Hess, A., & Stępińska, A. (forthcoming). Expert discourse on public opinion concepts and theories in the digital era: Insights from a survey. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.	PL, RO	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
7	Baden, C., Bączkowska, A., Balčytienę, A., Jungblut, M., Kligler-Vilenchik, N., Krstič, A., Lipiński, A., Salgado, S., Springer, N. & Zelenkauskaite, A. (forthcoming). Studying the negotiation of normative public opinion on digital media. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking	DE, IL, LT, PL, PT, RS	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y

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	opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.						
8	Zelenkauskaite, A., Springer, N., & Baden, C. (forthcoming). Shock and adaption in opinion research: Incivility, disinformation, and the authenticity challenge in synthetic generative AI content. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.	DE, IL, LT	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
9	Krstić, A., Milioni, D., Bajčeta, S., Kollyri, L., Kligler-Vilenchik, N., Bączkowska, A., Cunha, C., Djouvas, C., Dylgjeri, A., Kazazi, L., Kunić, T., Milojević, A., Novotna, M., Vesić, S., Zelenkauskaite, A., Hess, A., Gogo, V., Trilling, D., Gruber, J. B., Salgado, S., & Kouros, T. (forthcoming). Studying opinion expression in a comparative cross-platform perspective: A case study of European and national politicians' use of Facebook, X, and Instagram. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.	AL, HR, CY, CZ, FR, DE, IL, LT, NL, PL, PT, RS	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
10	Ruzaitė, J., Utka, A., Negrea Busuioc, E., Kazazi, L., Dylgjeri, A., Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, B., & Bączkowska, A. (forthcoming). Digital hostilities in flame wars: Antagonistic opinions on (mis)gendering on Reddit and YouTube. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.	AL, LT, PL, RO	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
11	Kristo, E., Reci, A., Jahiri, M., & Mistrean, L. (forthcoming). The role of political catchwords in opinion articles: A cross-disciplinary analysis of political communication. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges.	AL, MD	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y

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	Routledge.						
12	Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, B., Liebeskind, C., Harpaz, G., Kazazi, L., Dylgjeri, A., Lombart, E., & Bolatbek, M., (forthcoming). Opinion dynamics in social media climate change discourses. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.	AL, BE, IL, PL	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
13	Bączkowska, A., Lombart, E., Escoulaire, L., & Guzek, D. (forthcoming). The linguistic roles of emoticons and emoji in CMC: A large-scale cross-linguistic corpus analysis of English and French tweets. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.	BE, PL	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
14	Ciunova-Shuleska, A., Palamidovska-Sterjadovska, N., & Negrea Busuioc, E. (forthcoming). Examining social media influencers' motivations and restraints: A social exchange theory perspective. In A. Stępińska, C. Cunha, G. Szabó, A. Krstić, & A. Bączkowska (Eds.), Unpacking opinions: Cross-disciplinary theories, methods, and challenges. Routledge.	MK, RO	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
15	doi:10.51480/1899-5101.19.2(43).1144 Szabó, G. & Vochocová, L. (forthcoming). Cringe politics in the digital age: Humor and affective boundary-making in Central and Eastern European political communication. Central European Journal of Communication, 19(2), 188-196. Note: This is the editorial of a Special Issue edited by Szabó & Vochocová. The Special Issue furthermore contains 6 Articles by OPINION authors from 5 countries;	AL, CZ, HU, PL, RS	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y

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	these articles do not qualify individually, as each is authored by a different country's team, but we consider them jointly part of OPINION's outputs. These articles are: Syrovátka, J. & Vochocová, L. (forthcoming). “His squareness” Filip Turek and his engine boys: A case study of cringe political communication centred around gender-related issues. Central European Journal of Communication, 19(2), 197-219. Szabó, G., & Benedek, I. (forthcoming). Cringe communication in Hungarian politics: Insult comedy as campaign tool in 2024. Central European Journal of Communication, 19(2), 246-270. Bajčeta, S. & Krstić, A. (forthcoming). Cringe as a public evaluative affect: Negotiating authority–public relationships in the platform society. Central European Journal of Communication, 19(2), 271-288. Gugu, E., (forthcoming). Cringe as a form of emotional manipulation in Albanian digital campaigns (2025). Central European Journal of Communication, 19(2), 289-306. Guzek, D. (forthcoming). Book Review of V. Iché, C. Schneebeli, & L. Blin (2026, Eds.), Cringe humor on screen and in digital media: Pragmatic perspectives. Central European Journal of Communication, 19(2), 315-318.						
16	doi:10.26881/bp.2024.1.07 Bączkowska, A., Negrea Busuioc, E., Guzek D., Liebeskind, C., Hess, A., Crestani, F., Ravenda, F., Kunić, T., Lipiński, A., Lombart, E., Novotna, M., Kazazi, L., Macková, A., Dylgjeri, A., Milojevic, A., Cunha, C., Ruzaitė, J., Krstic, A., Milić, K., & Dłutek, A. (2024). Opinionated texts in social media: A proposal for evaluative judgement methodology. Beyond Philology, 21(1), 203-280.	AL, BE, HR, CZ, IL, LT, PL, PT, RO, RS, CH	Y	N	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
17	doi:10.1093/ijpor/edaf049 Baden, C., Kligler-Vilenchik, N., Springer, N., Jungblut, M., Zelenkauskaite, A., Balčytienė, A., Salgado, S., Lipiński, A., Krstic, A., & Bączkowska, A. (2025). Public opinion negotiations in a digital media ecosystem: A conceptual framework. International Journal of Public Opinion Research, 37(3), edaf049.	DE, IL, LT, PL, PT, RS	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y

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18	doi:10.1038/s41598-025-96508-3 Bojić, L., Zagovora, O., Zelenkauskaite, A., Vuković, A., Čabarkapa, M., Veseljević Jerković, S., & Jovančević, A. (2025). Comparing large language models and human annotators in latent content analysis of sentiment, political leaning, emotional intensity and sarcasm. Scientific Reports, 15(11477).	BA, DE, IE, LT, ME, RS	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
19	doi:10.1057/s41599-026-07255-3 Bojic, L., Seychell, D., & Cabarkapa, M. (2026). Towards a societal AI alignment benchmark for evaluating human–machine value convergence. Humanities and Social Sciences Communications, 13, 883.	MT, RS	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
20	doi:10.1093/ijpor/edag001 Hess, A., Negrea-Busuioc, E., Ciunova-Shuleska, A., Palamidovska-Sterjadovska, N., Stępińska, A., Bączkowska, A., Gërguri, D., Milioni, D., Veseljević Jerković, S., Mulahmetović Ibrišimović, A., Krstić, A., Gugu, E., & Reçi, A. (2026). Rethinking Public Opinion Studies in the Digital Era: Expert Discourse on the Theoretical and Methodological Challenges of Public Opinion Research, International Journal of Public Opinion Research, 38(1), edag001.	AL, BA, CY, MK, PL, RO, RS	Y	Y	Y	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
21	doi:10.1515/lpp-2023-0022 Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, B., Liebeskind, C., Bączkowska, A., Ruzaitė, J., Dylgjeri, A., Kazazi, L., & Lombart, E. (2023). Opinion events: Types and opinion markers in English social media discourse. Lodz Papers in Pragmatics, 19(2), 447-481.	AL, BE, IL, LT, PL	Y	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y

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22	Ruzaitė, J, Utka, A., Negrea-Busuioc, E., Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, B., Kazazi, L., Dylgjeri, A., & Bączkowska, A. (forthcoming, 2027). Challenges of Stance Annotation in Polarised Social Media Debates: Evidence from Misgendering Discussions on Reddit and YouTube. Journal of Language and Discrimination.	AL, LT, PL, RO	Y	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
23	doi:10.5117/CCR2026.2.11.URMA Urman, A., Domahidi, E., Gruber, J. B., Jovančević, A., Maier, M., Gërguri, D., Mazak, J., & van der Velden, M. A. C. G. (2026). Gender representation in Large Language Models: A cross-linguistic and cross-model analysis. Computational Communication Research, 8(2), 1-47.	CZ, DE, IE, NL, CH	Y	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
24	Sjøvaag, H. & Baden, C. (forthcoming). Working collaboratively in computational communication research: Past, present, and future perspectives. In Haim, M. & Domahidi, E. (eds). The handbook of computational communication research. Routledge.	IL, NO	Y	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
25	Ruzaitė, J, Utka, A., Negrea-Busuioc, E., Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, B., Kazazi, L., Dylgjeri, A., & Bączkowska, A. (2026). Trans-related Online Corpus (TROC), CLARIN-LT VDU Repository.	AL, LT, PL, RO	Y	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	N
26	González Baquero, W., Ferreira da Costa, B. D., & Blanco-Herrero, D. (2024, December 26). Polarización y desinformación: el reto de entender e interpretar la opinión pública en la era digital. The Conversation.	NL, PT, ES	Y	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	N

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27	Baden, C., Bączkowska, A., Balčytiene, A., Jungblut, M., Kligler-Vilenchik, N., Krstic, A., Lipiński, A., Salgado, S., Springer, N., & Zelenkauskaite, A. (2024). Everybody counts? Re-conceptualizing the aggregation of public opinion dynamics in digital spaces. Paper presented at the ECREA European Communication Conference, Ljubljana, Slovenia.	DE, IL, LT, PL, PT, RS	N	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
28	Milioni, D., Krstič, A., Bączkowska, A., Bajčeta, S., Cunha, C., Gogo, V., Kouros, T., Kunić, T., Milojević, A., & Novotna M. (2024). Studying opinion expression in a comparative cross-platform perspective: Conceptual and methodological challenges and strategies. Paper presented at the ECREA 10th European Communication Conference, Ljubljana, Slovenia.	AL, HR, CY, CZ, PL, PT, RS	N	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
29	Baden, C., Bączkowska, A., Balčytiene, A., Jungblut, M., Kligler-Vilenchik, N., Krstic, A., Lipiński, A., Salgado, S., Springer, N., & Zelenkauskaite, A. (2024). Public opinion as discursive process in a digital media ecosystem: A conceptual framework. Paper presented at the WAPOR Annual Conference, Seoul, South Korea.	DE, IL, LT, PL, PT, RS	N	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
30	Baden, C., Kligler-Vilenchik, N., Jungblut, M., Springer, N., Zelenkauskaite, A., Krstic, A., Salgado, S., Lipiński, A., Krstic, A., & Bączkowska, A. (2025). Public opinion as discursive process in a digital media ecosystem: A conceptual framework. Paper presented at the 75th ICA Annual Conference, Denver, CO, USA.	DE, IL, LT, PL, PT, RS	N	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
31	Gruber, J. B., Viehmann, C., Urman, A., Hase, V., Thiele, D., Lind, F., Trilling, D., Touileb, S., Stolwijk, S., Gloc, R., Adamczewska, K., Loecherbach, F., Vesic, S., Hess, A., Erisen, C., Gugu, E., Durmus Ozturk, S., Tomašević, A., Beck, T., Yun, B.,	AL, AT, FR, DE, IL, NL, NO, PL, RS, SI, CH, TR	N	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y

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	Jerele, T., Liebeskind, C., & Welbers, K. (2025). Textual feelings: A review of computational tools for measuring opinions in text. Paper presented at CompText 2025, Vienna, Austria.						
32	Gruber, J. B., Viehmann, C., Urman, A., Hase, V., Thiele, D., Lind, F., Trilling, D., Touileb, S., Stolwijk, S., Gloc, R., Adamczewska, K., Loecherbach, F., Vesic, S., Hess, A., Erisen, C., Gugu, E., Durmus Ozturk, S., Tomašević, A., Beck, T., Yun, B., Jerele, T., Liebeskind, C., & Welbers, K. (2025). Textual feelings: A review of computational tools for measuring opinions in text. Paper presented at Etmaal van de Communicatiewetenschap 2025, Bruges, Belgium.	AT, FR, DE, IL, NL, NO, PL, RS, SI, CH, TR	N	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
33	Liebeskind, C. & Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, B. (2024). Opinion identification using a conversational large language model. Paper presented at the 37th International FLAIRS Conference, Miramar Beach, FL, USA.	IL, PL	Y	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
34	Maurer, P., Urman, A., Gruber, J., Stolwijk, S., & Trilling, D. (2025). Dictionaries, machine learning, LLMs: A framework for deciding which approach to use for computational text analysis. Paper presented at CompText 2025, Vienna, Austria.	DE, NL, SE, CH	N	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
35	Maurer, P., Nasir, J. A., & Shinar, O. (2026). Measuring the framing of ICE in international news media. Paper presented at CompText 2026, Birmingham, U.K.	IE, SE	N	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
36	doi:10.1515/lpp-2024-0039 Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, B. & Liebeskind, C. (2024). Opinion events and stance	IL, PL	N	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y

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	types: advances in LLM performance with ChatGPT and Gemini. Lodz Papers in Pragmatics, 20(2), 413-432.						
37	Liebeskind, C. & Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, B. (2024). Navigating opinion space: A study of explicit and implicit opinion generation in language models. Proceedings of the 1st LUHME Workshop, 28–34, Santiago de Compostela, Spain.	IL, PL	Y	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
38	Hess, A., Stępińska, A., Negrea-Busuioc, E., Ciunova-Shuleska, A., & Bączkowska, A. (2025). Expert discourse on key theories and approaches to studying public opinion: A concept map analysis. Proceedings of the International Conference "Economic and Business Trends Shaping the Future", Skopje, North Macedonia.	MK, PL, RO	N	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
39	Negrea-Busuioc, E., Hess, A., Stępińska, A., Ciunova-Shuleska, A., & Bączkowska, A. (2025). Rethinking public opinion studies in the digital era: Expert discourse on the theoretical and methodological challenges of public opinion research. Proceedings of the International Conference "Economic and Business Trends Shaping the Future", Skopje, North Macedonia.	MK, PL, RO	N	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
40	Harpaz, G., Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, B., Liebeskind, C., Bolatbek, M. (forthcoming, Eds.). Special Issue: Thinking about opinions: Formation, discourse, re-examination, and changing opinions in the streaming era. Social Sciences.	IL, PL	Y	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y
41	doi:10.5281/zenodo.15865457 Szabó, G., Cunha, C., Ruzaitė, J., & Kunić, T. (Eds.). (2025). OPINION Glossary:	IL, TR, SK, RS, RO, PT, PL, MK, LT, AL, HU, DE, DK,	Y	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	Y

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	Integrating theory and methods for automatically analyzing opinionated communication. OPINION COST Action CA21129. https://www.opinion-network.eu/glossary The Glossary includes 141 unique entries authored by: Janet Adikpo, Anna Bączkowska, Christian Baden, Barbora Baďurová, Madalina Boțan, Anita Ciunova-Shuleska, Nicoleta Corbu, Carlos Cunha, Ardita Dylgjeri, Dren Gërguri, Valmora Gogo, Gal Harpaz, Agnieszka Hess, Marc Jungblut, Ledia Kazazi, Neta Kligler-Vilenchik, Aleksandra Krstic, Tamara Kunić, Barbara Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, Chaya Liebeskind, Artur Lipiński, Erika Lombart, Franziska Marquart, Ana Milojevic, Dimitra L. Milioni, Elena Negrea-Busuioc, Martina Novotná, Şule Yüksel Özmen, Serap Durmuş Öztürk, Nikolina Palamidovska-Sterjadovska, Alena Pospíšil Macková, Jana Rosenfeldová, Jūratė Ruzaitė, Nina Springer, Agnieszka Stępińska, Gabriella Szabó, Lenka Vochocová, Annie Waldherr, Asta Zelenkauskaite	CZ, CY, HR, BE, AT					
42	Negrea Busuioc, E., Baden, C., Stepinska, A., Cunha, C., Badurova, B., Ciunova-Shuleska, A., Gërguri, D., Harpaz, G., Hess, A., Kunić, A., Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, B., Palamidovska-Sterjadovska, N., Zelenkauskaite, A. (2025). The OPINION Manifesto. OPINION COST Action CA21129.	HR, IL, LT, MK, PL, PT, RO, SK	Y	Y	N	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies	N

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Projects resulting from Action activities

Please enter below all the projects on the topic of the Action resulting from Action activities, involving at least one Action participant, and for which the Action networking was necessary.

The Action reported 1 project(s) and 1 proposal(s) resulting from the Action networking.

Key details of the projects are shown below.

#	Title	Countries participating in the Action	Main proposer name	Funder	Amount	Call identifier	Relevance to H2020 Soc challenge

		among proposers					
1	How to study public opinion in a digitalized world? Conceptualization - methods - technique	AL, BA, CY, MK, PL, RO, RS	Agnieszka Hess	Other	18000 €	Jagiellonian University Krakow, Grant Program Competition 2024 International Interdisciplinary Cooperation	Europe in a changing world, inclusive innovative and reflective societies

Other outputs / achievements

Please enter below any additional outputs/ achievements on the topic of the Action that contribute to the COST mission: “COST enables break-through scientific developments leading to new concepts and products and thereby contributes to strengthen Europe’s research and innovation capacities", and for which the Action networking was necessary (e.g. a patent, standards, white paper).

Output / achievement description	Dependence of achievement on the Action networking
Baden, C., Cunha, C., Gogo, V., Hess, A. & Jungblut, M. (with Bączkowska, A., Ciunova-Shuleska, A., Gerguri, D., Kunić, T., Negrea Busuioc, E., Palamidovska-Sterjadovska, N., Reci, A., Springer, N., Waldherr, A. & Zelenkauskaite, A. (2024). Opinion in public opinion theory and research. OPINION Review of Literature.	High
Cuhna, C., Lipiński, A., Hess, A., Guzek, D., & Bączkowska, A. (with Negrea-Busuioc, E., Ruzaitė, J., Lombart, E., Novotna, M., Macková, A., Kunić, T., Dylgjeri, A., Kazazi, L. Krstic, A., Milojevic, A., Milioni, D., Gogo, V., & Zelenkauskaite, A.) (2024.)Opinions in Communication and Media Studies. OPINION Review of Literature. (part of Deliverable 1, published online on https://opinion-network.eu and in line for publication as part of the WG1 book project, Deliverable 3)	High
Lewandowska-Tomaszczyk, B., Ruzaitė, J. & Harpaz, G. (with Dylgjeri, A., Lombard, E., Kazazi, L., Liebeskind, C., Bolatbek, M., & Bączkowska, A.) (2024). Linguistics. OPINION Review of Literature. (part of Deliverable 1, published online on https://opinion-network.eu and in line for publication as part of the WG1 book project, Deliverable 3)	High
Lipiński, A., Rosenfeldová, J., Szabó, G., & Vochocová, L. (with Bączkowska, A., Botan, M., Buturoiu, R., Corbu, N., Gërguri, D., Hess, A., & Stępińska, A.) (2024). Political communication and cultural studies. OPINION Review of Literature. (part of Deliverable 1, published online on https://opinion-network.eu and in line for publication as part of the WG1 book project, Deliverable 3)	High
Stępińska, A., Corbu, N., & Cunha, C. (Eds.) (2004). OPINION Glossary of Opinion Research. With contributions from A. Hess, A. Krstic, A. Macková, A. Milojevic, A. Ciunova-Shuleska, A. Bączkowska, A. Waldherr, A. Dylgjeri, A. Lipiński, A. Zelenkauskaite, B. Lewandowska-	High

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Tomaszczyk, C. Cunha, C. Liebeskind, C. Baden, D. Milioni, D. Gërguri, E. Negrea-Busuioc, E. Lombart, F. Marquart, G. Szabó, G. Harpaz, J. Rosenfeldová, J. Adikpo, J. Ruzaitė, L. Kazazi, L. Vochocová, M. Boțan, M. Jungblut, M. Novotna, N. Kligler-Vilenchik, N. Corbu, N. Palamidovska-Sterjadovska, S. Durmuş Ö., Ş. Yüksel Özmen, S. Salgado, T. Kunić, & V Gogo. (part of Deliverable 1, published online on https://opinion-network.eu)	
King'Ang'i, W. (host), Domahidi, E., & Haim, M. (producers). Observing Opinions. 13 Podcast Episodes. https://aboutccs.net/opinion/	High
Working Group 2: Tools. COST-OPINION-Tools. Inventory of Tools. https://meteor.medem.eu/detail/collection_opiniontoolscostaction	High
Working Group 3: COST-OPINION-Data. Inventory of data sets. https://meteor.medem.eu/detail/collection_costopinion	High
Working Group 4: OPINION Network Learning Resources. https://github.com/Opinion-CA21129/learning-materials/	High

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Impacts

Please describe the impacts (the short- to long-term scientific, technological, and / or socioeconomic changes produced by a COST Action, directly or indirectly, intended or unintended) that have resulted, or might result, from the Action in the following table (one impact per line).

Description of the impact, i.e. what will change, and for whom, as a result of what the Action achieved	Type of impact	Timing of impact
OPINION's primary impact consists in its bringing together many of the key actors in European text-based computational political and communication research together with interdisciplinarily oriented researchers (computational) linguistics and computational sciences, enabling new discussions and collaborations that are likely to transform the field of text-based computational social sciences and result in a more transdisciplinary organization of the field. We believe that the many cross-disciplinary collaborations listed above already constitute an important impact in this direction: Many collaborations involve partners both from the traditionally leading and less well-resourced institutions, and cut across both disciplinary, East-West and North-South divides. In this way, OPINION has already helped create a landscape wherein researchers collaborate much more widely and diversely, accumulating a considerable amount of knowledge and expertise that could not be gleaned from either field alone, and its legacy will continue to do so in the future.	• Scientific / Technological	Achieved
OPINION has established conceptual and methodological standards in the field, pushing back on the uncritical use of unvalidated tools and the loose use of proxies and conceptually vague variables as is presently often still the case. OPINION authors' work is cited to credit definitions, best practices and validation procedures, and to justify research pushing boundaries identified by the network's work.	• Scientific / Technological	Achieved
OPINION's training mission has begun to impact the field by fostering not only the spread of computational research skills, but also advancing the intergenerational dialogue between junior and senior researchers, which is still often obstructed by the limited literacy in computational methods found especially among senior scholars.	• Scientific / Technological	Achieved
OPINION has enabled numerous young scholars, as well as researchers from under-resourced institutions with limited internationalization, to access the international stage and formulate their own contributions to the debate. To this end, OPINION has not only financially supported 24 STSMs and 10 conference grants of different types; but it has also bred a space where new researchers could make new connections, practice presenting to an international audience, and team up with internationally visible peers. We are noticing OPINION members among the first-time attendees of various European and global conferences, such as ICA, APSA, ACL, ECREA, EPSA, CompText and others.	• Scientific / Technological	Achieved
OPINION functions not only as a research network but also as a hub and accelerator for future research. Under the OPINION umbrella, Grant-Writing Collectives have emerged that bring together researchers to develop new collaborative projects and funding proposals. In this way, OPINION's outreach extends beyond the network itself: external researchers can become involved in its core activities, while ideas, collaborations, and research agendas initiated within OPINION continue to evolve and generate impact beyond the network's formal activities and duration. So far, only one grant proposal has actually been funded, but we know of several more that are in the making and will hopefully fund cutting-edge collaborative research involving several new players in the European Research Area in the near future.	• Scientific / Technological	Foreseen within two years

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OPINION's economic and societal impacts of the network's activities are mostly indirect: By raising methodological standards and communicating key insights toward stakeholders, OPINION hopes to influence the state of the art in commercial opinion research, including both survey-based polling and more qualitative approaches. In this way, industry actors may benefit both from the improved transparency of tools and approaches, and the superior accuracy and validity that can be achieved by following OPINION recommendations. This in turn may aid the maintenance of societal debates wherein current approaches to opinion research unduly simplify or underrepresent important aspects of opinionated communication (e.g., becoming aware that not all demands made loudly on social media actually represent very common or important, or even sincere positions), potentially contributing to raising the quality of political discourse and counteracting polarization. However, OPINION cannot achieve these impacts by itself, but only to the extent that more nuanced and well-informed approaches are adopted by industry and regulatory actors.	• Economic • Societal	Foreseen two-to-five years

Please describe how the Action has advanced careers, skills and network of researchers, including Early Career Investigators (for example: joint supervision of graduate and PhD students, research exchanges not funded by the action, collaborations, Training Schools with ECTS accreditation, joint projects, internship and job prospects.

YRIs were central to OPINION's work, whether as part of the CG (notably, Kasper Welbers as GHSC, Johannes Gruber as WG2 Chair, David Blanco Herrero as WG4 Vice Chair), as hosts of major meetings (e.g., Bruno Yun, Regina Seiwald, Felicia Loecherbach), as trainers in the Training Schools (e.g., Aleksandr Tomasevic, Aleksandra Urman, Ana Jovancevic) and as lead authors of various publications, presentations, and other outcomes (e.g., Aleksandra Urman, Olga Zagovora, Christina Viehmann, Dren Gerguri). OPINION's primary impact on YRIs' careers comes from network-facilitated collaborations. All WG-produced outcomes and almost all collaborative work within the network included YRI authors working alongside senior scholars. OPINION created various opportunities for YRI to present their work to senior, international and transdisciplinary audiences (notably, at OPINION's Hackathon in Ljubljana, the OPINION Preconference at CompText in Birmingham, and at OPINION's Final Conference in Zagreb, with a majority of YRI authors in each case) and introducing YRI to opportunities for joining grants proposals and other events. About half of all grants were allocated to YRI. OPINION also amplified the work and expertise of junior members via its dissemination tools (the podcast, social media activities).

The career benefits were mainly to researchers with the following amount of experience after their PhD: ≤ 8 years.

Which of the stakeholders described in the "Plan for involving the most relevant stakeholders" in the Action's MoU have been engaged and how? What additional stakeholders have been, or will be, engaged and how? This information will not be included in the Action Report that is made publicly available (on the website).

OPINION's primary stakeholders comprises text-based researchers of opinionated communication across numerous academic disciplines. OPINION engaged this group through meetings, publications and presentations at scientific meetings, as well as specialized events (e.g., the 2024 ECREA special panel, the OPINION Preconference at the 2026 CompText, the OPINION Hackathon). This facilitated close collaboration among researchers from theoretically, methodologically, and geographically diverse backgrounds. Beyond academia, OPINION engaged several groups of professional stakeholders. A collaborative project funded by the Jagiellonian University supported a series of interviews with professional pollsters and opinion researchers (Hess et al.), and a webinar continued this effort as public engagement. The network's final conference invited activists, journalists, policy analysts, pollsters, and political decision makers for a structured conversation. Professional stakeholders were furthermore engaged via a podcast series (13 episodes) discussing key issues and recommendations for application. Ongoing engagement with scholarly and professional communities relies on the Action's published research, open-access repositories, and training materials, which constitute enduring resources empowering interdisciplinary training, applied research and validation,

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and cross-border comparative work and collaboration. Post-Action outreach will target European policy advisers, regulatory authorities, and digital media practitioners, distributing key recommendations (e.g., the OPINION Manifesto), to ensure sustained, practical impact.

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Dissemination and exploitation of Action results (other than co-authored Action publications listed previously)

Please describe the Action's dissemination and exploitation approach as well as all activities undertaken to ensure dissemination and exploitation of the Action results and the effectiveness of these activities.

Dissemination and exploitation approach of the Action

As a network, OPINION does not generate outcomes that are directly suitable for exploitation; rather, the conceptual and methodological innovations are designed to improve the traction, validity and comparability of opinion-related research activities across various disciplines and industries. Exploitation thus happens indirectly: OPINION's dissemination activities inform practitioners and academic researchers about the strategies, standards and insights collated by the network. To the extent that the so-addressed researchers then follow our recommendations, apply skills gained from participating in OPINION's training activities, or otherwise make use of insights brought about by the network, their work should gain in accuracy, improving the validity of research, the commercial value of professional analyses, and also the societal relevance and reliability of policy-related analyses and uses. However, it is beyond the scope of this Action to directly create exploitation by professional stakeholders.

Dissemination

Dissemination meetings funded by the Action (possible only until 31st October 2021)

Title of Dissemination meeting	Meeting date	Meeting country	Action participant	Event name and hyperlink to the website	Title of presentation	Description of added value to the Action
N/A						

Other dissemination activities

E.g. participation to non-Action meetings, e.g. EU Parliament, meetings with policy makers, experts in the field, regional authorities.

Item/activity	Target audience	Outcome	Hyperlink
OPINION hosted, upon invitation by ECREA, a special panel on OPINION at the 10th European Communication Conference in Ljubljana.	The ECREA European Communication Conference is the main meeting of European Communication Scholars	We had a packed room (>50 attendees) and good discussions with many attendees, and are expecting several more membership applications as a result.	https://c-in.floq.live/event/ecrea2024/search?objectClass=timeslot&objectId=668d22076a86a7d7bd1e4f1d&type=detail
OPINION has produced a mini-series of webinars different stakeholder groups	Opinion researchers inside and outside of academia who make use of computational	There was limited stakeholder/public interest in the event, so we did not pursue	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1tAaw0BAvC6IsFhe4VY_m2h4SQduJCJ0g/view?usp

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(hosted by E. Negrea-Busuioc).	strategies for studying opinionated text	this further.	=share_link
OPINION has produced a podcast series (hosted by M. Haim, E. Domahidi, and W. C. King'ang'i) focused on the work of the network. Each episode contains a conversation with an OPINION expert on selected issues in research and analysis.	Computational social scientists and the general public, to the extent that it is interested in contemporary issues in social science research.	13 episodes were produced and released via various commercial podcast platforms, accumulating over 1,200 plays in total, around 100 per episode.	https://aboutccs.net/opinion/
OPINION has organized a preconference at the CompText annual conference in Birmingham, focused on ongoing work within the network.	Participants in the CompText annual conference and members of the wider CompText community: Computational Social Science researchers in political science, sociology, communication, economics, psychology, and beyond.	A handful of CompText participants joined our preconference; however, most participants of the pre-conference also attended the main conference, and more than a dozen OPINION authors had presentations also at the adjacent CompText conference.	https://www.comptextconference.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/04/Comptext26_Programme-1.pdf
OPINION's Final Conference included a full day of stakeholder engagement, including two roundtable discussions with invited journalists, pollsters, policy analysts, political decision-makers and activists.	We invited numerous journalists, local politicians and activists, as well as a few guest speakers - notably, a policy analyst, a pollster, a journalist, and a politician/activist to join our conference.	Beyond our invited guests, about a dozen stakeholders participated in the event. Guests included national television journalists (who produced a brief report on the evening news), a former president of Croatia, as well as other professional multipliers. There were several news reports relating mostly to the theme of toxic opinion expression and public opinion pressure, discussed in the roundtables and many presentations.	https://youtu.be/NX2xKqW357E?is=2_hVyOKXYi_Y55Fe
OPINION opened its Computational Opinion Analysis (COpA) Training School in Zagreb for participation by non-members. The training school focused on the use of AI technologies for the analysis of opinionated textual data.	Young researchers in science and industry interested in cutting-edge AI tools for textual research	COpA III was attended by 28 researchers, including two non-members and three others who joined OPINION for the purpose of the training school or attended an event for the first time.	https://www.opinion-network.eu/updates/cost-action-training-school-in-zagreb-croatia_2026-06-14
OPINION Members have presented OPINION's work at numerous international conferences in their respective fields, including (but not limited to): The International Communication Association annual conference, the Association of Computational Linguistics annual meeting, the Contacts & Contrasts conference,	Academic researchers all across the Social Sciences and Humanities, from regional to global meetings	We did not collect feedback for every individual conference talk, but most talks that we know about were well-attended and resulted in various questions and conversations after the event.	https://www.opinion-network.eu/results

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Critical Approaches to Discourse Analysis Across Disciplines conference, the ECREA European Communication Conference, the World Association for Public Opinion Research conference, the FLAIRS conference, CompText conference, Etmaal van de Communicatiewetenschap, and the Economic and Business Trends Shaping the Future conference. About ten of these participations were supported by OPINION's grants.			

Exploitation activities

Please describe below any activities undertaken to ensure exploitation (use, in particular in a commercial context) of the Action's achievements.

Item/activity	Target audience	Outcome
The OPINION Final Conference included direct conversations with important stakeholders in journalism, politics, and policy advice, exchanging priorities and conveying key recommendations to practitioners.	Regulators, decision makers, journalists, pollsters, activists, and other users of opinion research tools in a professional capacity; also, the general public as far as interested	Including invited stakeholders, the conference was mostly attended by members of the Croatian and Serbian parliaments, a few regional activists, a Romanian policy analyst, as well as various media representatives and journalists. We know of at least three items of news coverage that resulted from the presence of media.
The OPINION Manifesto was promoted across digital channels, leveraging the official COST Action LinkedIn page for targeted posts and reposts.	Textual Opinion Researchers across academia and industry, interested in maintaining adequate validity and quality standards in research	The Manifesto was downloaded more than two hundred times, and the posts were re-shared two-three dozen times across different social media channels. Beyond social media, the Manifesto gained mainstream media visibility, notably featuring in a dedicated segment on Romania's public service radio, București FM. Broadcast as part of the "Break the Fake" series addressing online opinion formation and algorithms, this coverage brought the Manifesto's core insights to a broad public audience. Together, these combined social and broadcast media efforts ensured strong visibility across both professional and civil society spheres. https://www.bucurestifm.ro/2026/03/04/break-the-fake-emotii-si-algoritmi-cum-se-formeaza-opiniile-pe-

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		internet-si-de-ce-ne-afecteaza/
OPINION members organized a Panel Discussion “Public Opinion 2.0: Challenges in the Digital Age and Possible Research Directions” at the 2025 EBTSF Conference, Ss. Cyril and Methodius University, Skopje (North Macedonia), 14 November 2025.	Scholars, researchers, and practitioners at the intersection of economics, business, management, and emerging technologies	Moderated by Prof. Dr. Anita Ciunova-Shuleska (North Macedonia), the panel provided a venue to showcase the Action’s scientific framework regarding digital opinion dynamics, algorithmic influence, and computational methodologies. The session successfully fostered interdisciplinary dialogue, expanding the network’s outreach and exploiting its research findings for broader academic and practitioner communities. The OPINION panel discussion was well attended and resulted in numerous conversations at and beyond the conference. https://ebtsf.eccf.ukim.edu.mk/panel/
Several OPINION members presented work from the network at the 2025 Contacts & Contrasts Conference in Lodz, including three keynote talks (by Prof. Christian Baden, Prof. Agnieszka Stepinska, and Prof. Omnia Zayed)	Scholars in philology and linguistic researchers from across Europe and beyond	The hybrid conference was well-attended, including numerous overseas participants who joined the program via Zoom.
The OPINION network is expanding its public outreach through publications on the news platform The Conversation. In 2024, an article exploring polarization, disinformation, and the complex challenges of interpreting public opinion in the digital age was published in the Spanish-language edition. This piece positions the OPINION’s core mission within pressing societal debates, introducing its research goals to a broad, non-academic audience. In 2026, a second article entitled "The digital agora in crisis: A Manifesto for understanding public opinion in the age of AI” was submitted and is currently awaiting a decision regarding acceptance. This article introduces the network’s Manifesto. This article warns how AI, platform affordances, and algorithmic amplification distort genuine human sentiment, creating a gap between held and expressed opinions. It issues an urgent call for updated computational research tools, structural transparency, and widespread media literacy.	General Public audiences interested in the state of social media and digital text analytics, in particular in the context of the study and monitoring of public opinion.	The first piece was published in 2024; the second is still in process: González Baquero, W., Ferreira da Costa, B.D., & Blanco-Herrero, D. (2024). Polarización y desinformación: el reto de entender e interpretar la opinión pública en la era digital. The Conversation, https://doi.org/10.64628/AAO.gcn35vajm Negrea-Busuioc, E., Guy, D., & Blanco-Herrero, D. (submitted).The digital agora in crisis: A Manifesto for understanding public opinion in the age of AI Together, these contributions strategically amplify OPINION’s mission to decode digital-era opinions for a broad, non-academic audience. Regrettably, we do not have access to The Conversation's usage statistics.
There have been one successful (Hess et al.) and one unsuccessful (Springer et al.) grant proposal initiatives seeking to exploit insights of OPINION's works in our own research. For details, see the grants section of the report.	Academic researchers, professional pollsters (in the case of Hess et al.) and practitioners in public opinion research	The granted proposal resulted in sustained conversations with some professionals, as well as a joint publication in IJPOR. The rejected proposal did not generate immediate results.
We tried to apply for a Dagstuhl seminar, a format offered by the Leibniz Institute for Informatics at Dagstuhl Palace in Germany, wherein 30-50 researchers from IT and other disciplines gather for a	Researchers in informatics and computer science, especially those with a focus on AI-based textual research	Regrettably, the proposal was rejected by the Dagstuhl selection committee.

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week-long unconference. The theme of the submission was Validity standards for AI in opinion research.		

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Action Success(es)

Taking into account the achievements, impacts and policy implementation of the Action described in the preceding sections, please describe below the two most significant successes of the Action.

Description of the success	OPINION significantly strengthened cross-disciplinary exchanges especially between computational social sciences and computational linguistics, as evidenced not only in various collaborations and joint publications, but also cross-cutting conference participation (e.g., OPINION linguists joined CompText; OPINION social scientists joined the Contacts & Contrasts Conference). The cross-disciplinary exchange of knowledge is evident is most publications that arose from the network, and promises to shape the future evolution of the field for many years.
Dimensions of the success	• Scientific breakthrough • Building capacity in bridging separate fields of science and technology • Building capacity in a new or emerging field of science and technology

Description of the success	Over three training schools, about a hundred researchers, a majority of them from ITCs, received focused methods training in computational opinion analysis. OPINION supported 24 STSMs and 9 ITC/YRI travel grants, many of which revolved around collaborative work between researchers who had met only through the network, and most of which resulted in publications. With these efforts, OPINION has now trained a significant share of the next generation of computational social science researchers in several European countries, who are moreover networked and familiar with cross-disciplinary collaboration. We have high hopes for these YRI carrying the work of OPINION into the future, shaping both their domestic institutions' evolving efforts at integrating computational textual research, and the pan-European connectivity of the field as a whole.
Dimensions of the success	• Scientific breakthrough • Building capacity in a new or emerging field of science and technology • Building capacity in the demographic inclusiveness of networks in science and technology, including representation of newly established research groups, Early-Career Investigators, the under-represented gender and teams from countries/regions with less capacity in the field of the Action

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Other matters

This section is confidential to the Management Committee, the Action Rapporteur and the COST Association, and is not included in the version of the report that is published on the COST website.

Difficulties in implementing the Action

If any difficulties were experienced in the implementation of the Action (e.g. imbalances of participation across the Working Groups, inactive country representatives) please described these below. Please also describe the efforts made by the MC to address these.

The main challenge arose from the fact that the leader of WG3 fell ill shortly after the inaugural meeting and was henceforth unavailable to orchestrate the WG's activities. At that time, no vice chair had yet been appointed. The CG sought and quickly appointed a new WG3 chair who, however, then missed his first meeting with the WG due to flight cancellation. By the time the WG was back on track, many members had drifted toward other WGs, leaving WG3 to mostly work with temporary participants. Various efforts to bring back sustained members to contribute to WG3 (including joint activities with WG2, direct persuasion) had only limited success.
A lesser challenge arose from the successful progress of work within the WGs, which required an active effort to stimulate coordination across WGs. This was addressed successfully via the establishment of cross-cutting panels at joint meetings, active mediation by the core group, as well as informal coordination that took place via the many collaborative research projects that emerged from the Action and usually involved members of multiple WGs.
Overall, we were pleased with the MC's support, which offered helpful discussions and guidance, and collaborated in the making of quick decisions where necessary.

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Suggestions for improvements to COST framework/ procedures

The mandate of the Scientific Committee includes providing advice to the COST Committee of Senior Officials on possible improvements to the COST framework. Please describe below any improvements that you believe should be made to the COST framework.

The framework works and supports the networking activities well, recent changes (in applications, YRIG) are appreciated. Key areas for consideration are: Visa are an issue for non-Schengen/UK citizens, especially participants from Turkiye often failed to obtain visa on time. The action, lacking legal status, cannot issue more than informal invitation letters. COST as IGO could be much more helpful. Even carrying over small sums (e.g., 5000) of budget/expenses from one GP to the other would significantly reduce the structural underspending owed to the need for worst-case budgeting and uncertain costs of meetings in August/September, an important time slot for meetings. Rights in e-COST could be slightly expanded for the (Vice-)Chair to include viewing claims/commitments and creating contacts/defining invitee lists. Vice-GCOs might be enabled to access grant applications, and application documents should be downloadable as single PDF. We would appreciate if all CNCs would accept non-tenured, often YRI participants as MC members, as per COST rules. We tried and failed for Slovakia. If e-COST could include auto-subscribed mailing lists (i.e., lists that members can post to) for all members, each WG, and the MC (with basic moderation functions), that would significantly facilitate communication.

Sustaining the network beyond the Action

Are there any plans to sustain the network beyond the end of the Action?	YES

Please describe how the network will be sustained beyond the end of the Action.

We have initiated a process of transferring the active part of the Action membership into the CompText Association, which pursues objectives fully compatible with those of OPINION, sharing its transdisciplinary and expression-focused stance. CompText organizes annual conferences that can act as venues for future meetings among Action members, and a springboard for collaboration. As OPINION will cease to exist as a network in its own right, accordingly, parts of it will become part of the wider scholarly community of CompText, and there enabled to initiate events (workshops,

preconferences, meetings) built upon the Action's work.

Emerging topics/ developments in the field of the Action

Please describe any emerging topics or potentially important future developments identified during the Action and that could potentially be addressed by future COST activities such as Actions S&T Conferences or Exploratory Workshops.

The advent of Generative AI raises many methodological challenges that became apparent during OPINION's lifetime, but will require focused attention in future research. Key among these are inherent biases in the technology, cross-cultural/-lingual incommensurabilities, challenges for validation, and ethical concerns.
OPINION also identified wider challenges in textual opinion research, which concern the ambiguity/polysemy of text-based classification and the structural limitations of stance detection approaches confronted with natural language uses that express opinions indirectly, or in relation to somewhat different focal objects.
Toxic opinion expression and the use of opinionated discourse to create public pressure and intimidate other speakers has long constituted a key research agenda and will require quite a bit more work.
The measurement of opinion expression is directly related to efforts at moderating toxic expression (and there are also authoritarian efforts at moderating the expression of dissent). The practical implications of improved measurement, as well as its ethical dimension, require future attention.
The same is true about efforts at automated measurement (e.g., for audience/customer satisfaction metrics, public policy analysis, public opinion research). OPINION has laid the foundations for valid, technology-supported measurement, but its practical application for industry and stakeholders still raises many important challenges.

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Annex 1: Types of objectives

1 - Coordination of scientific and technological activities at a European level

1.a - Development of a common understanding/definition of the subject matter

1.b - Coordination of information seeking, identification, collection and/or data curation

1.c - Coordination of experimentation or testing

1.d - Comparison and/or performance assessment of a theory, model, methodology, technology or technique

1.e - Development of knowledge needing international coordination, pertaining to a new or improved theory, model, methodology, technology or technique

1.f - Achievement of a specific tangible output that cannot be achieved without international coordination (e.g. due to practical issues such as database availability, language barriers, availability of infrastructure or know-how, etc.)

1.g - Input to stakeholders (e.g. standardization body, policy-makers, regulators, users), excluding commercial applications

1.h - Input for future market applications (including cooperation with private enterprises)

1.i - Dissemination of research results to the general public

1.j - Dissemination of research results to stakeholders (excluding specific input in view of knowledge application)

2 - Community building

2.a - Building a community around a topic of scientific and/or socio-economic relevance, allowing for knowledge exchange and the development of a joint research agenda

2.b - Building a community around a new or emerging field of research

2.c - Bridging separate fields of science/disciplines to achieve breakthroughs that require an interdisciplinary approach

2.d - Acting as a stakeholder platform or trans-national practice community, pertaining to a certain area of socio-economical or societal application, or to a certain market sector

2.e - Building capacity in the demographic inclusiveness of networks in science and technology, including representation of newly established research groups, Early-Career Investigators, the under-represented gender and teams from countries/regions with less capacity in the field of the Action

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Annex 2: Dimensions of successes

1 - Breakthroughs

- 1.a - Scientific breakthrough
- 1.b - Technological breakthrough
- 1.c - Breakthrough in socio-economic or societal applications

2 - Policy contribution

- 2.a - Contribution to regulatory policy
- 2.b - Contribution to environmental, infrastructural or agricultural policy
- 2.c - Contribution to economic or socio-economic policy
- 2.d - Contribution to social, cultural or legal policy

3 - Capacity building

- 3.a - Building capacity in an existing field of science and technology
- 3.b - Building capacity in bridging separate fields of science and technology
- 3.c - Building capacity in a new or emerging field of science and technology
- 3.d - Building capacity in valorising and implementing advances and applications in science and technology
- 3.e - Building capacity in the demographic inclusiveness of networks in science and technology, including representation of newly established research groups, Early-Career Investigators, the under-represented gender and teams from countries/regions with less capacity in the field of the Action

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